

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Rashed Karim

Address: 65 Downs Road Sutton SM2 5NR

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing as a local resident of Belmont to express my strong support for planning application DM2025/01591, submitted by the local community for the conversion of the former ambulance garage into a community centre and place of worship.

This application matters deeply to me, and I would ask the Council to consider not just the planning merits but the genuine community need that underpins it.

Belmont and the wider Sutton borough is home to a significant and long-established community, yet our residents, including many families with young children, currently have no dedicated local facility for Islamic education, faith-based wellbeing activities, or community gathering. While other faith communities in the area are well served by churches and other places of worship, Muslim residents have had to travel considerable distances or go without. This application addresses that gap in a measured and responsible way.

On the planning merits themselves, I am satisfied that the proposal is sound. The design is sympathetic to the character of the surrounding area, modest in scale, well-considered in appearance, and unlikely to detract from the neighbourhood's aesthetic. The conversion of an existing building, rather than new construction, is itself a sensitive and proportionate approach. The proposed programmes, Islamic education for children and young people, wellbeing initiatives, and broader community activities, will provide structured, positive opportunities for residents of all ages and backgrounds. A well-run community centre of this kind does not serve only one group; it strengthens the social fabric of the whole neighbourhood by giving young people in particular a safe, purposeful environment.

I respectfully urge the Council to approve this application. It represents exactly the kind of thoughtful, community-led development that Sutton should be proud to support, filling a real and

long-standing need, in a building that fits its surroundings, run by a community that has demonstrated care and responsibility in how it has brought this proposal forward.